

“The **MiGs reacted as we hoped.** To make a wonderfully long story short, **they lost.**”

COLONEL ROBIN OLDS, SAIGON NEWS CONFERENCE, 1967

» AFTER

Under President Nixon, the air war mainly focused on Laos and Cambodia.

THE AIR WAR SHIFTS

After Operation Rolling Thunder, the intensity of air-to-air and SAR actions decreased in Vietnam. Instead, the USAF bombed NVA and Viet Cong bases in **Laos** and **Cambodia**. Bombing in Vietnam flared up again during **Operation Linebacker I** in 1972.

THE ARVN AIR FORCE

The Nixon administration restricted ARVN aircraft to helicopters and short-range planes to prevent Saigon from expanding the war to North Vietnam. This meant that it was poorly prepared for a conventional attack such as the **Easter Offensive** in 1972.